

Community waiting list within 18 weeks

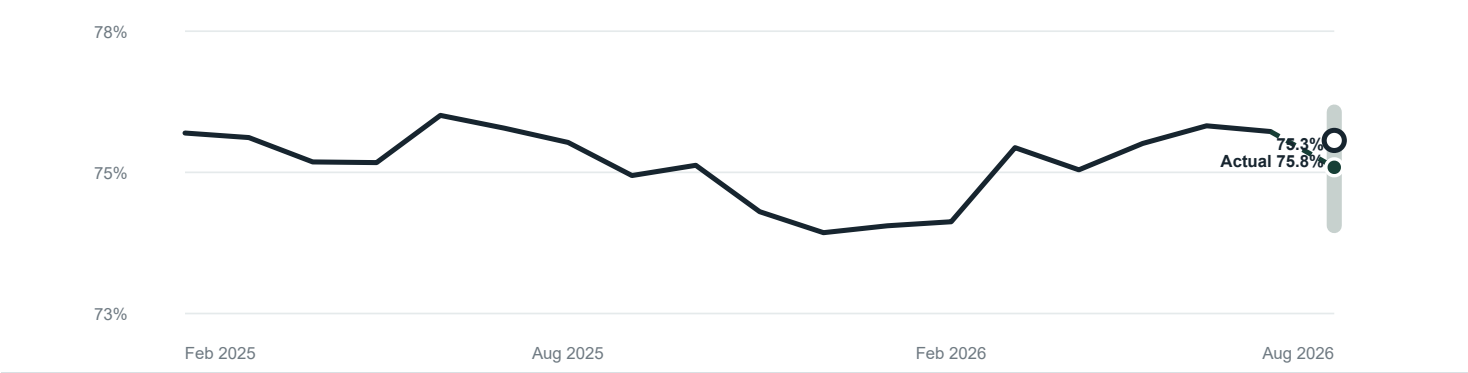
Outturn for August 2026 • forecast issued with data through July 2026

The published result was 75.8%. It was 0.5pp better than outlook • inside the 80% range. The provider distribution and trajectory watch have been refreshed using the new release.

LATEST • JULY 2026	OUTLOOK • AUGUST 2026	ACTUAL
75.9%	75.3%	75.8%
No archived pre-release forecast	80% range 74.2%–76.3%	0.5pp better than outlook • inside the 80% range
		Off course • 78% by March 2027

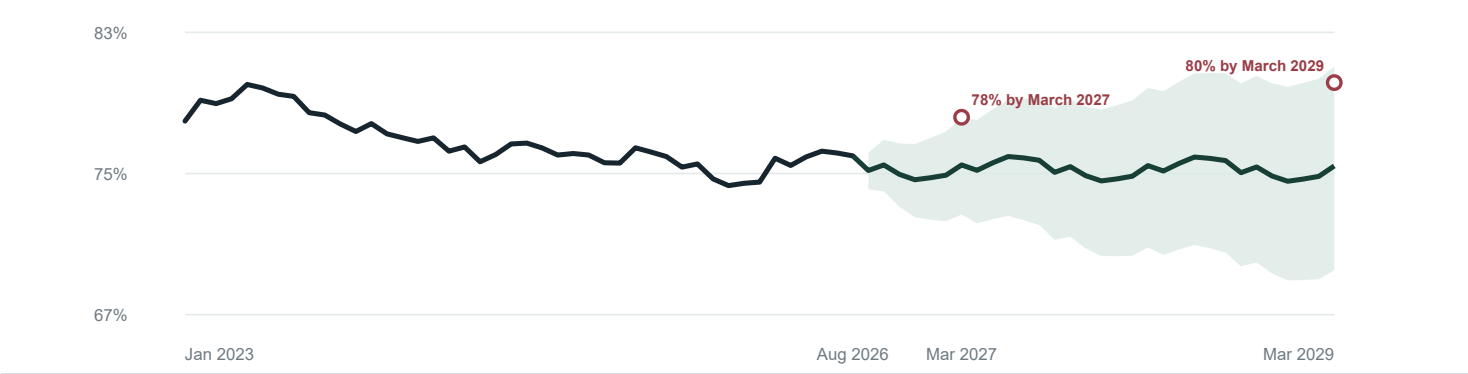
Recent performance and current release

The vertical band is the 80% expected range.



Longer-term outlook and milestones

Descriptive projection; not forced to meet targets.



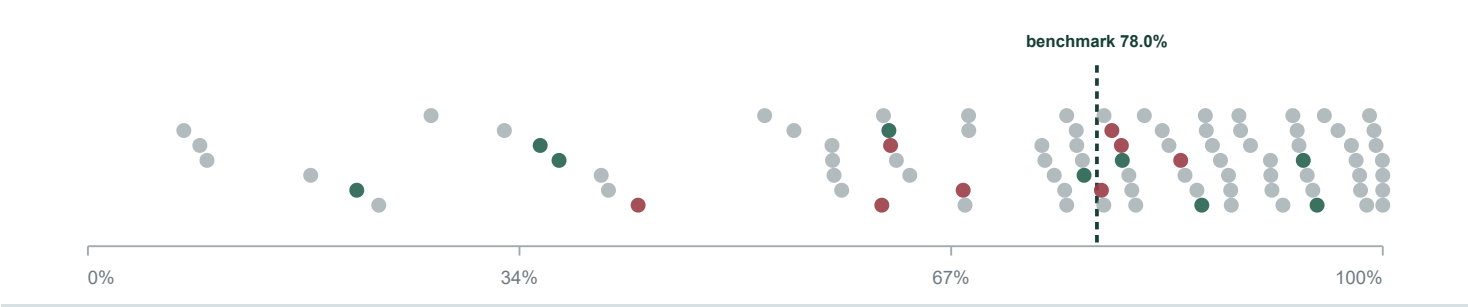
Benchmark: 80% by March 2029. 2.8pp below milestone
Data: NHS England community health services waiting lists. **Targets:** Medium Term Planning Framework interim target - Medium Term Planning Framework final target
Method: Backtest-weighted ensemble of current-level seasonal movement, damped annual drift and a damped recent seasonal trend; at least 2 components are required. The final fit uses 44 consecutive months. Accuracy is tested on 12 rolling one-month-ahead forecasts. The 80% range uses empirical historical error quantiles from 12 forecast errors. Weights use inverse rolling RMSE and are shrunk toward equal weights. The pre-release commentary compares the current-level seasonal component with the combined forecast. Provider distribution and trajectory watch are shown on page 2.

Community waiting list within 18 weeks

Distribution and trajectory watch · July 2026

Provider distribution

Latest reported performance across providers. This is a comparison of current levels, not a measure of whether each provider is improving or deteriorating.



Trajectory watch

Signals show sustained departures from each provider's own archived outlook. A low performer can be improving, and a high performer can be deteriorating. Status: Actual performance is compared with the monthly path forecast six months earlier. The displayed figure is the average gap across those six months.

48 providers assessed	9 sustained favourable	8 sustained adverse	31 without an active signal
Largest sustained favourable moves		Largest sustained adverse moves	
DONCASTER AND BASSETLAW TEACHING HOSPITALS NHS FOUNDATION TRUST Latest 36.6% · 6 months compared with a path fixed six months earlier fixed six month path backtest		FRIMLEY HEALTH NHS FOUNDATION TRUST Latest 79.9% · 6 months compared with a path fixed six months earlier fixed six month path backtest	
44.3pp AVERAGE GAP FROM FIXED PATH		19.8pp AVERAGE GAP FROM FIXED PATH	
UNIVERSITY HOSPITALS PLYMOUTH NHS TRUST Latest 80.0% · 6 months compared with a path fixed six months earlier fixed six month path backtest		WHITTINGTON HEALTH NHS TRUST Latest 62.1% · 6 months compared with a path fixed six months earlier fixed six month path backtest	
16.8pp AVERAGE GAP FROM FIXED PATH		14.7pp AVERAGE GAP FROM FIXED PATH	
DERBYSHIRE HEALTHCARE NHS FOUNDATION TRUST Latest 35.1% · 6 months compared with a path fixed six months earlier fixed six month path backtest		COUNTY DURHAM AND DARLINGTON NHS FOUNDATION TRUST Latest 78.3% · 6 months compared with a path fixed six months earlier fixed six month path backtest	
14.1pp AVERAGE GAP FROM FIXED PATH		6.3pp AVERAGE GAP FROM FIXED PATH	

Trajectory-watch rule. Six actual months are compared with the corresponding path fixed before the six-month window. A signal requires a material average gap, at least five of six months in the same direction, and the latest month confirming that direction. These are screening prompts—not league tables, causal estimates or judgements of provider quality.

Community waits by service

England · August 2026

SERVICE MIX

Where waits over 18 weeks are concentrated

Services differ greatly in size. This ranks the published service categories by the number waiting over 18 weeks; it is a descriptive breakdown, not a forecast or provider comparison.

47

services with a reported total waiting list

43

services with complete published over-18-week bands

SERVICE	TOTAL WAITING	OVER 18 WEEKS	WITHIN 18 WEEKS
Community paediatric service	174,537	129,158	26.0%
Musculoskeletal service	456,532	78,025	82.9%
Therapy interventions: Speech and language	58,114	20,122	65.4%
Podiatry and podiatric surgery	113,132	15,689	86.1%
Therapy interventions: Occupational therapy	19,992	6,015	69.9%
Nursing and Therapy support for LTCs: Continence/ colostomy	44,259	5,996	86.5%
Therapy interventions: Physiotherapy	49,316	5,406	89.0%
Therapy interventions: Dietetics	35,793	5,178	85.5%
Audiology	16,214	5,064	68.8%
Therapy interventions: Speech and language	28,297	4,710	83.4%
Rehabilitation services (integrated)	46,590	3,720	92.0%
Audiology	16,079	3,379	79.0%
Therapy interventions: Physiotherapy	20,054	2,688	86.6%
Neurorehabilitation (multi-disciplinary)	13,806	2,517	81.8%
Therapy interventions: Dietetics	8,354	2,091	75.0%

Coverage and interpretation. Ranked by the published number waiting over 18 weeks. Complete over-18 bands were available for 43 of 47 services with a reported total. Rows with suppressed or incomplete bands are excluded from the ranking. The national headline on page 1 remains the authoritative aggregate. The within-18-week percentage is total waiting less all published over-18-week bands, divided by total. NHS England notes that the sum of weekly bands may not match the total where some providers were still collecting waits by weeks; reconciliation differences are retained in the QA outputs.